

PIANO TEACHING & ORFF-SCHULWERK

utilising
AMEBSERIES4
PIANO4LEISURE

WORKBOOK
for teachers

presenters



Susan Head & Paul Nyatt

Contents

What is Orff?	3
Your Reflections	5
AMEB P4LS4 Grade Overview	
Preliminary	6
Grade 1	7
Grade 2	8
Grade 3	10
Grade 4	12
Bourée Ensemble (Gr 4)	14
Exploring Improvisation (Twilight)	18
Questions for Listening	18
Synonyms for Dynamics	18
P4L Prep-Gr4 - Exam Overview	19
Aural Test Overview	20
Notes to Remember	21
Information to Parents	23
Student Weekly Timetable	26
General Knowledge Handout Example	28
Circle of 5ths Handout Example	29
Remember how to play your scales	30
Time Names	31
Solfa Hand signs	32

A digital copy (with working links) of this workshop handout is available to workshop participants at:
www.easylearnmusic.com/sydcon

A brief history

Orff Schulwerk is a participatory approach to experiencing and learning about music. Developed by the composer Carl Orff (composer of *Carmina Burana*) and his colleague Gunild Keetman, this approach has its beginnings where the worlds of dance and music meet and collaborate: in the 1920's in Munich, at the Guntherschule which trained young women in elemental music and dance with equal emphasis. "Out of music, movement & out of movement, music". Orff created music for dancers based on their movements, sometimes it was the reverse, the music came first and the dancers created the movement. Sometimes the dancers played instruments.



Gunild Deetman was one such dancer and became Orff's main collaborator in developing this approach. As a performer, composer, and teacher, she is also credited with co-developing the educational pathways known today as the Orff Schulwerk. This approach became more formalised and directed to the education of children through a series of broadcasts for Bavarian Radio in 1948.

In 1949 teacher training in Orff Schulwerk began at the Mozarteum in Salzburg, Austria. In 1961, the Orff Institute started to train teachers and provide music education classes for children. Today it is the centre for Orff practitioners all over the world. The institute offers summer symposiums in English every two years as well as other courses of study. There are now 29 national Orff Schulwerk Associations Worldwide.

About the Approach

Tell me: I forget
Show me: I remember
Involve me: I understand
(Ancient Chinese Proverb)

This proverb is often quoted in reference to the Orff Approach, as participation is fundamental in every lesson. Students are not spectators, they are involved in making music. Involvement comes from many sources: Stories, speech rhymes, songs, dances, body percussion, drums and other non melodic or melodic percussion. Music is embodied and explored. Activity and play is the key to success. Creativity is the high point of activity. Improvisation develops skills in music and assists with developing confidence as well as building understanding of all aspects of the language of music.

Play & discovery are elemental. Rather than being told what, how or why, the student is encouraged to be curious, to question and observe, while listening or playing music games or creating a dance. Observations can be investigated and experimented with. Students are then encouraged to make new music creations. There is an inherent freedom in the approach, which supports the natural development of each individual's musical mind. During the whole process, learning is carefully scaffolded by the teacher to ensure that the environment for creativity is a safe one.

Recent Flow Theory* studies suggest that students engaged in Orff Schulwerk activities not only acquire musical knowledge through moving, singing, dancing and playing percussion, but they also live out optimal flow experiences. This is achieved by balancing high levels of skills and challenges which produce a high output of ideas, productivity, satisfaction and forward momentum.

The elements of music: rhythm, melody, texture, harmony and form are always present but the emphasis and activity will be carefully selected to highlight just one whilst the others are being subliminally absorbed. Simultaneous learning is another key element in the process.

Lessons in Orff Schulwerk are planned as a developmental process, but in all cases the starting point is artistic. Known concepts are practised first before new ones are introduced as per the old adage in education of going from the known to the unknown. Demonstrated in the approach by:

- the simple to the complex
- sound before symbol
- text to rhythm
- body first
- instrument second
- drone accompaniment
- ostinati

* Flow Theory:

In Positive Psychology, flow, also known as the zone, is the mental state of operation in which a person performing an activity is fully immersed in a feeling of energized focus, full involvement, and enjoyment in the process of the activity.

(Concept Creator:

Dr Mihaly Csikszentmihalyi)

Theoretical concepts are revealed through practical experience such as participating in performance and creative work; then, based on the learning experience, discussed, recorded and notated.

Summary of ideas for the lesson to teach the Elemental concepts of:

- Rhythm
- Melody
- Harmony
- Structure

Media:

- Speech
- Singing
- Movement and Dance
- Non melodic percussion
- Melodic percussion
- Personal instruments

Process:

- Exploration
- Imitation
- Improvisation
- Notation
- Integration
- Arrangement
- Composition

Supporting techniques:

- Drone
- Rhythmic ostinati
- Melodic ostinati
- Body percussion to instrument
- Dance and listening

It is hard to write a few sentences which encapsulate Orff Schulwerk - many books have been written on the subject! It is our hope that this workshop may open the door for you to explore a new approach to teaching music. You'll definitely get some ideas to help awaken the musical potential of your piano students through utilising different activities.

Your reflections

A series of horizontal dotted lines for writing reflections.

PRELIMINARY GRADE Piece	Teaching Point Ideas	Metre	Key	Movie Theme Show Tune or Existing Song	Movement or Dance	Mood evoking eg Atmospheric Character	Jazz and/or Jazz Features	"Classical" Genre	20th Century &/or Contemporary
March of the Toreadors	Listening and moving for "2 in a bar feel"	4/4	C/F						
Saxophone Blues	Swing sneakily Lyrics: Saxophone sings blues, saxophone rings out, Saxophone sings blues, ringing out loud & proud. R R Saxophone x 2 Playing out loud. RR Saxophone x2 Out & proud. loud.	4/4	Dm						
Bourrée	Improv G major scale with dynamics over a tonic dominant drone Dynamic Range	4/4	G						
Three plus two	3+2 Body Percussion Dynamic Range	3+2/8	Am/C						
The Singing Sioux	Slur Motif repetition and retrograde	4/4	Am/ Em						
Moonlight Variation	Intervals & direction	2/4	G					Broken Triads	
March of the Cubs	Beat in feet & hand percussion	4/4	C						
Just Jazzin'	Singing pitch direction of walking bass	4/4	Gm				Walking bass		
Winter's Day	Walk the bass line sing the phrase	3/4	Dm/F						
Square-o	2 note slurs	4/4	C				Walking bass		
Full of Confidence	Walk the bass line say the rhythm in scat sounds	4/4	C Blues				Swung & 12 Bar Blues Scale		
Waltzing Matilda	Sing song with dynamics & bassline	4/4	F						

GRADE 1 Piece	Teaching Point Ideas	Metre	Key	Movie Theme Show Tune or Existing Song	Movement/Dance or Body Percussion	Mood evoking eg Atmospheric Character	Jazz and/or Jazz Features	"Classical" Genre	20th Century &/or Contemporary
Going Baroque	A - Articulation - clap staccato with time names B - RRLRR-Stamp	(Cut) C	Em						
Jive Turkey	"Here comes the jivin jivin turkey (4th) or chicken (5th) Accented grace notes (Acciacatura)	4/4	C Blues				12 Bar Blues		
Trumpet Tune*	See Trumpet & Organ example: https://youtu.be/B0Fjxx2RNEk	4/4	C						
Dance of the Gnomes	LRLR PPPPP C	4/4	Am						
Warm Starry Nights	Percussion, Duet learning - a difficult song for this grade.	4/4	G						
Dudes Keep Struttin'	Walking bass - Swing RH Improv possibilities	4/4	Dm						
Prayer	LH Ostinato: 2 Fingers & Pedal, Together then separate. Improv RH: D mixolydian	4/4	D mix- lydian						
Sea Bird	LH Ostinato, Story Telling, Poem	4/4	D Dorian						
A Wild Chase	Hand co-ordination & lightness of touch & slow practice	6/8	Am						
Overture	YouTube Bugs Bunny https://youtu.be/uYBce9Gsz7g Dynamics	4/4	Em						
In Dreams	Sing words https://youtu.be/gyY3Op47Uto Alternating phrases Question/Answer	4/4	C						
La Donna è Mobile	Identify Primary Harmony: I & V7 Sing in Solfege: mmm sfr rrr fmd mfd dtt rdl lss :	3/4	F						

GRADE 2 Piece	Teaching Point Ideas	Metre	Key	Movie Theme Show Tune or Existing Song	Movement/Dance or Body Percussion	Mood evoking eg Atmospheric Character	Jazz and/or Jazz Features	"Classical" Genre	20th Century &/or Contemporary
Whatever	Swing quaver against staccato & legato bass line on the beat. Staccato leaps (inc 8ve).	4/4	D						
Greased Lightnin'	Rhythmic Percussive Modified 12 bar blues https://youtu.be/wK63eUyk-iM	4/4	C Blues				C Blues Scale		
Mayfly	Double TC hands move a lot across keyboard. Contrary Motion	C	C						
On the Champs- Élysées	Stylistic triple time	3/4	C			French			
Polka	Staccato duple time accompaniment style https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Polka	2/4	Dm						
Microwaltz	$\frac{3}{4}$ accompaniment style with pedal. Great for pedalling practice	3/4	C	Very Disney Song Style					
Secret Agent	Bass ostinato, walking bass. Lyrics (use dynamics): A Secret Agent x 4 Who's the agent? Secret Agent Watch Out! x 2 Secret Business x 2 B What's your secret I'm not telling, It's a secret not for selling, What's your secret I'm no telling you. A Getting out of here! Now!	4/4	Em				Walking Bass Swing Quaver 12 Bar blues in A section		

GRADE 2 cont Piece	Teaching Point Ideas	Metre	Key	Movie Theme Show Tune or Existing Song	Movement/ Dance or Body Percussion	Mood evoking eg Atmospheric Character	Jazz and/or Jazz Features	"Classical" Genre	20th Century &/ or Contemporary
The Castle Ball	Start with outside chord notes with RH melody for alberti phrasing. Rotate wrist for Alberti Bass Dynamics	C	F						
Mad World	Lots of repetition! The challenge is to make the song sound interesting. Explore improvisation. See synonyms for Dynamics for creative ways to develop dynamic contrast.	4/4	E Dorian						
Spider's Web	LH melody and RH staccato accompaniment & lots of dynamics	4/4	Am						
Boogie Woogie Rock	Scale passages - syncopated beat on (1 & 2.5 & 4) Boogie LH	4/4	C				Boogie LH		
The Stowaway	Double Bass Clef - making this sound good on a low quality instrument will be difficult. ie. sempre pp will be difficult to achieve. Potential for story telling. Lyrics A Section: Down among the dead men, they lie x 2 Down among the dead men x 2 Down among the, down among the dead men lie.	4/4	Dm						

GRADE 3 Piece	Teaching Point & Ideas	Metre	Key	Movie Theme Show Tune or Existing Song	Movement/Dance or Body Percussion	Mood evoking eg Atmospheric Character	Jazz and/or Jazz Features	"Classical" Genre	20th Century &/or Contemporary
Toccata Ritmico	Rhythmic patterns Perpetual motion Hemiola	6/8 & 3/4	Bb						
I still call Australia Home	Sing the song https://youtu.be/hbGuqmaDgLA Holding the melody against the inner accompaniment.	3/4	F/Am						
Twilight	Not suitable for small hands. Standard pop bass line. Imprvo in C pentatonic - great for pedal practice.	4/4	C						
Midnight Ride	Ask student to play the LH while teacher demonstrates the RH so they get the feel of 12/8. Identify the semitones. Hand crossing in the B section & Coda.	12/8	Em						
Misty	Accurate Pedal required. Rubato is essential for a great performance https://youtu.be/rPOlakkBlj8	4/4	G						
The little would-be Man	Classical Ballet travelling step with a 6/8 feel although it is a waltz.	3/4	F/C						
Spanish Dance	Legato 3rds & Habanera feel. https://youtu.be/jXKUb5A1auM https://youtu.be/QugLFzedHzk	4/4	Am/ Dm A / D						
Song of Twilight	Clean clear pedalling required on every beat to give the music flow. Improv on Pentatonic.	C	A/F#m						

GRADE 2 cont. Piece	Teaching Point & Ideas	Metre	Key	Movie Theme Show Tune or Existing Song	Movement/ Dance or Body Percussion	Mood evoking eg Atmospheric Character	Jazz and/or Jazz Features	"Classical" Genre	20th Century &/or Contem- porary
Nashville Rag	Simple Rag LH staccato Tonic Dominant pattern.	4/4	C						
I Dreamed a Dream	Pedalling required to give the correct feel. Not suitable for small hands. Learn to sing the song: https://youtu.be/86lczf7Bou8	4/4	F/ Gm/G						
Morning Prayer	SATB classic harmony. Play inner parts & outer parts.	3/4	G						
Buckaroo	Rotating wrists	4/4	G						

GRADE 4 Piece	Teaching Point Ideas	Metre	Key	Movie Theme Show Tune or Existing Song	Movement/Dance or Body Percussion	Mood evoking eg Atmospheric Character	Jazz and/or Jazz Features	"Classical" Genre	20th Century &/or Contemporary
Allegro	Rolling wrists for the arpeggio & rotating wrist to bring out the melodic line in RH & LH	C	F/C/ Dm						
Tambo Tango	Difficult for small hands. Play as a duet to start to get the "feel". Composer performance: https://youtu.be/lhsKtfPVskg	4/4	Bm						
Let the good times roll	Relaxed arm and hands for chord shifts	4/4	C				Rock feel		
Allegro con fuoco	Short nails! Technique will show! Fast accented tumbling fingers need lightness Accompaniment available: https://www.easylearnmusic.com/ameb-gr4-allegro-con-fuoco	C	Am/ Dm						
Twilight	Rotating Rh wrist to bring out melody Clear Pedalling	4/4	G						
Grand-mother's Minuet	Rhythmically tricky -listen & step to the beat a la minuet style to get the feel	3/4	G/Em						
Sunday morning	Careful pedalling for atmospheric gorgeousness. Australian 20C painters 	4/4	Bm/D/ F#m						
GRADE 4 cont. Piece	Teaching Point Ideas	Metre	Key	Movie Theme Show Tune or Existing Song	Movement/Dance or Body Percussion	Mood evoking eg Atmospheric Character	Jazz and/or Jazz Features	"Classical" Genre	20th Century &/or Contemporary

Theme from New York New York	Highlight the melody -Sing song and play only accompaniment https://youtu.be/hpiw3cDWmvc	4/4	F/G						
Kitten 'n' mousin' on the keys	Great for teaching 4 part harmony, secondary dominants Fast scales	4/4	C/F						
Jazz Train	Metre changes Chromaticism & swung quavers	4/4 & 3/4	G blues						
My Old Movie Blues	Words to bar 2 "my old movie blues" Rh play LH boogie pattern. 12 bar blue, boogie bass & Rh syncopation	12/8	C blues						
Bourée	Even balanced parts for both hands. Ensemble opportunities.	Cut C	Gm/ Bb/ Dm						

Bourée Ensemble - Stölzel

$\text{♩} = 76$

Clarinet in B $\flat$

Oboe

Bassoon

Harpsichord

B $\flat$ Cl.

Ob.

Bsn.

Hpschd.

The first system of the musical score for the Bourée Ensemble by Stölzel. It features four staves: Clarinet in B $\flat$, Oboe, Bassoon, and Harpsichord. The Clarinet in B $\flat$ staff begins with a treble clef, a key signature of two flats (B $\flat$ and E $\flat$), and a common time signature (C). It contains a melodic line with a long slur spanning the first four measures. The Oboe staff also has a treble clef and the same key signature and time signature, with a more rhythmic line. The Bassoon staff uses a bass clef and the same key signature and time signature, with a line that includes some accidentals. The Harpsichord part is written for both treble and bass staves, with a treble clef and the same key signature and time signature. It features a continuous, flowing accompaniment.

The second system of the musical score for the Bourée Ensemble by Stölzel. It features four staves: B $\flat$ Cl., Ob., Bsn., and Hpschd. The B $\flat$ Cl. staff has a treble clef, a key signature of two flats, and a common time signature. It contains a melodic line with a slur. The Ob. staff has a treble clef, a key signature of two flats, and a common time signature, with a line that includes a slur. The Bsn. staff has a bass clef, a key signature of two flats, and a common time signature, with a line that includes a slur. The Hpschd. part is written for both treble and bass staves, with a treble clef and a key signature of two flats. It features a continuous, flowing accompaniment.

10

B♭ Cl.

Ob.

Bsn.

Hpschd.

15

B♭ Cl.

Ob.

Bsn.

Hpschd.

19

B♭ Cl.

Ob.

Bsn.

Hpschd.

Measures 19-22. B♭ Cl. (B-flat Clarinet) and Ob. (Oboe) have melodic lines. Bsn. (Bassoon) has a sustained low note. Hpschd. (Harp) has a rhythmic pattern in the right hand and a sustained low note in the left hand.

23

B♭ Cl.

Ob.

Bsn.

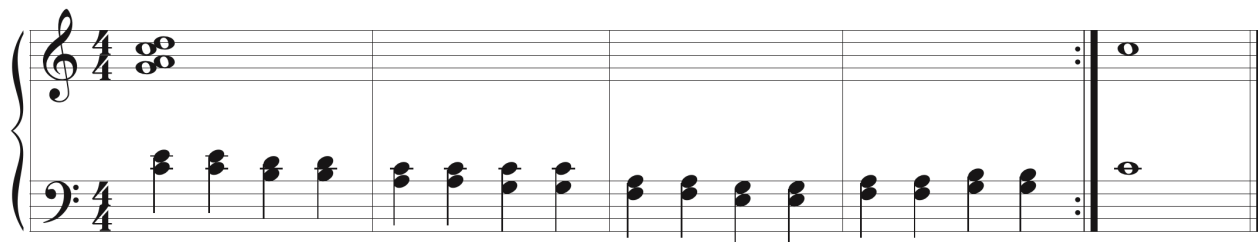
Hpschd.

rit. (2nd time only)

3

Measures 23-26. B♭ Cl. (B-flat Clarinet) has a melodic line with a trill in measure 24. Ob. (Oboe) has a melodic line. Bsn. (Bassoon) has a melodic line with a trill in measure 24. Hpschd. (Harp) has a rhythmic pattern in the right hand and a melodic line in the left hand. A *rit. (2nd time only)* marking is above the B♭ Cl. staff. A '3' marking is above the B♭ Cl. staff in measure 24.

Exploring Improvisation before learning "Song of Twilight" - Grade 3



What is twilight?
What does it look like?
What does it sound like?
How do you feel when you're sitting and experiencing twilight?

Close your eyes and imagine.

Play the LH and then add one note per bar as you play in the RH. When you feel more confident, explore with more notes. Does it sound good? If it doesn't sound good, you're probably only a note away from something that sounds amazing!

Synonyms for Dynamics

pp	p	mp	mf	f	ff
Pianissimo	piano	mezzo piano	mezzo forte	forte	fortissimo
very quiet	quiet	not so quiet	not so loud	loud	very loud
very delicate, extremely delicate, murmur, hint, trace, secret, concealed, seductive, private,	delicate, gentle, light, sensitive, soothing, amiable, courteous, soft, tame, patient	mild, moderate, calm, cool, willing, temperate, mellow,	full, ready, solid, open, present, forward, unfolding	strong, robust, vigorous, energetic, convincing, effective, heavy, direct, assertive, deliberate, confident	forceful, powerful, mighty, intense, wild, crazy, massive, huge, exciting, thrilling, ferocious

Questions for Listening

Passionate?	Joyful	Dull?	
Moving?	Uplifting?	Monotonous?	
Exciting?	Adventurous?	Expressive?	
Compelling?	Inviting?	Full of Vitality	
Intimate?	Intimate	Restful?	
Fun?	Full of Character?	Calm?	

AMEB: Piano for Leisure Exams

Preliminary	Grade 1	Grade 2	Grade 3	Grade 4
Pieces: 3 Pieces	Pieces: 3 Pieces	Pieces: 3 Pieces	Pieces: 3 Pieces	Pieces: 3 Pieces
Scales: Major: C, G Harmonic Minor: A, E 2 octaves hands separately MM=100 1 note/beat	Scales: Major: C, G Harmonic Minor: A, E 2 octaves hands together & separately MM=84 2 notes/beat	Scales: Major: G, D Harmonic Minor: E, B Melodic Minor: E 2 octaves hands together & separately MM=108 2 notes/beat	Scales: Major: F, Bb Harmonic Minor: D, G Melodic Minor: D 2 octaves hands together & separately MM=63 4 notes/beat	Scales: Major: Bb, E Harmonic Minor: G, C# Melodic Minor: G 4 octaves hands together & separately MM=72 4 notes/beat <i>All piano or forte.</i>
Contrary Motion: Major: C MM=66 1 note/beat	Chromatic Scale: Commencing: C 1 octave Hands separately MM=84 2 notes/beat	Chromatic Scale: Commencing: D 2 octaves Hands separately MM=108 2 notes/beat	Chromatic Scale: Commencing: F 2 octaves hands together & separately MM=63 4 notes/beat	Chromatic Scale: Commencing: Bb 4 octaves Hands separately & hands together MM=72 4 notes/beat <i>All piano or forte.</i>
	Contrary Motion: Major: C Harmonic Minor: A MM=66 2 notes/beat	Contrary Motion: Major: G Harmonic Minor: E MM=80 2 notes/beat	Contrary Motion: Major: F Harmonic Minor: D MM=80 2 notes/beat	Contrary Motion: Major: Bb Harmonic Minor: G MM=52 4 notes/beat
	Broken Chord: Major: C MM=48 3 notes/beat Hands separately	Broken Chord: Major: G Minor: E 1 Octave MM=76 2 notes/beat Hands separately	Broken Chord: Major: F, A Minor: F, A Root Position 2 Octaves MM=76 2 notes/beat Hands separately	Arpeggios: Major: Bb, E Minor: Bb, E Root Position 4 Octaves Hands separately MM=76 2 notes/beat
Aural Test OR Sight Reading	Aural Test OR Sight Reading	Aural Test OR Sight Reading	Aural Test OR Sight Reading	Aural Test OR Sight Reading
General Knowledge	General Knowledge	General Knowledge	General Knowledge	General Knowledge

Free Download available to
workshop participants at:
www.easylearnmusic.com/sydcon

Aural Tests for AMEB Exams Preliminary – Grade 4

	Time	Rhythm	Pitch	Pitch
Preliminary	Clap the beats of a simple chord passages played in two or three beat time by the examiner at varying speeds – slow, moderate and quick, and to continue clapping or beating after the examiner ceases to play.	Hum, sing, clap or tap the note values of a simple rhythmical two-bar passage played by the examiner.	Sing or hum the notes of a short melodic phrase of five or six notes of one beat length. The examiner will first play the phrase and then repeat it, waiting on each note for the candidate to sing the note.	To state which is the higher or lower of any two notes played separately, not less than a third apart.
	Rhythm	Pitch	Pitch	Pitch
Grade 1	The examiner will play a passage in duple or triple time. The candidate will then tap or clap the passage.	Hum or sing a short phrase played twice by the examiner, combining melody and time.	Hum or sing the tonic at the end of a short unfinished phrase played by the examiner.	
Grade 2	The examiner will play a passage in duple or triple time. The candidate will then tap or clap the passage.	Hum or sing a short phrase played twice by the examiner, combining melody and time.	Hum or sing the higher or lower of two notes a major third or a perfect fifth apart within the limits of an octave from middle C played simultaneously by the examiner.	
Grade 3	The examiner will play a passage in duple or triple time. The candidate will then tap or clap the passage and state whether it is in duple or triple time.	Hum or sing a short phrase played twice by the examiner, combining melody and time.	Hum or sing the higher or lower any two notes within the limits of an octave from middle C played simultaneously by the examiner.	The examiner, having sounded on the piano a note to be regarded as the keynote of the scale, the candidate will hum or sing and afterwards name the interval of the second, third, fourth or fifth of the major scale as played by the examiner, in succession to the keynote.
Grade 4	The examiner will play a passage in duple or triple time. The candidate will then tap or clap the passage and state whether it is in duple or triple time.	Hum or sing from memory the higher or lower part of a two-part progression of two successive intervals within the compass of an octave from middle C as played by the examiner.	The examiner, having sounded any major or minor triad either in root position or an inversion played within the limits of an octave, the candidate will hum or sing the middle note.	The examiner, having sounded on the piano a note, to be regarded as the keynote of the scale, the candidate will hum or sing and afterwards name any interval of the major scale as played by the examiner immediately after the keynote.

Notes to remember about exams

This information has been transcribed from the AMEB Syllabus and provided to teachers as a guide. You should familiarise yourself with the current Syllabus and Hand Book.

Technical Work	The candidate is required to demonstrate: • A comfortable and well-balanced seating position • Appropriate hand and finger shape • Accurate and prompt performance from memory of all Technical Work requested by the examiner • Performance of the Technical Work at the indicated minimum tempo or faster • Independent action of the fingers • Smooth passing of the thumb under the hand in scales and arpeggios • Controlled co-ordination of the hands • Systematic fingering in scales and arpeggios • Controlled, even tone in all Technical Work • An increasing range of dynamic levels • A clear, even, legato touch • A crisp, even, staccato touch (for Grade 3 and Grade 4) • Appropriate phrasing and shaping of each part in the Canon (Grade 1 Classical)
Pieces	Through a programme of three works drawn from the lists, the candidate is required to demonstrate: • Accuracy and fluency • Rhythmic and metric stability • Articulation of legato, non-legato and staccato textures as required • Musical phrasing and punctuation • Development of increasing awareness of the dynamic range of the piano • Expressive realisation of dynamics • Control of variations in tempo, tone and touch • Control of variations in the tonal balance between the hands • Understanding of the style and character appropriate to each work • Execution of ornaments appropriate to each style/period • Although the use of the sustaining pedal is encouraged, the development of a legato pedalling technique is not demanded in Level 1 examinations. • Extra lists (Grades 2, 3 and 4 only) - familiarity with Extra List pieces by performing the whole or any part of them at the discretion of the examiner
Aural Tests	• Aural Tests will be played twice. • Interval Tests: Boys whose voices are at the 'breaking' stage may respond to the pitch tests by whistling instead of humming or singing. • Grade 3 interval recognition requires candidates to name the interval as being the second, third, fourth, or fifth of the scale. • In Grades 4, 5 and 6, candidates are required to name the intervals as major second, major third, perfect fourth, etc.

Sight Reading	- Preliminary (For Leisure syllabuses only), Grades 1 and 2: A test will be set consisting of a simple phrase of an elementary nature. - Preliminary Piano for Leisure and Grade 1 Piano and Piano for Leisure will be hands separately only. - Grades 3 to 8: A test will be set within the limits of the technical standard of the grade. The candidate is required to demonstrate: - Accuracy of notes, time and rhythm - Fluency
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Results	
High Distinction A+	In addition to satisfying the requirements for an A grading (below), the candidate demonstrates outstanding achievement in meeting the syllabus objectives in all Sections, including performance flair, consistent technical fluency and penetrating stylistic insight.
Honours A	The candidate demonstrates an overall superior level of achievement in meeting the syllabus objectives in all Sections, in terms of musicianship, security of technique (including intonation, tone, phrasing, articulation, rhythm), and stylistic awareness.
Credit B+	In addition to satisfying the requirements for a B grading (below), the candidate demonstrates meritorious achievement against most of the syllabus objectives.
B	The candidate demonstrates an overall creditable level of achievement with appropriate development of musicianship, technique and stylistic awareness in accordance with the syllabus objectives. Some unevenness of achievement in meeting the syllabus objectives or between different Sections of the examination, may be apparent.
Satisfactory C+	In addition to satisfying the requirements for a C grading (below), the candidate demonstrates more than adequate achievement against some of the syllabus objectives in each Section.
C	The candidate demonstrates an overall adequate level of achievement in musicianship, technique and style in accordance with the syllabus objectives. Considerable unevenness of achievement in meeting the syllabus objectives, or between different Sections of the examination, may be apparent.
Not Satisfactory – D	The candidate demonstrates an overall inadequate level of musicianship, technique and style and does not satisfy the syllabus objectives. Often this has resulted from inadequate preparation. Presentation is often hesitant, evidencing technical errors and/or an inappropriate sense of style.

Thinking about exams?

Exams are certainly not required or necessary for the enjoyment or for the many educational and brain enhancing benefits learning music provides. They are simply one way of making the journey towards playing music.

There are many schools of thought on the benefits of music exams for students. In some students they create a great sense of achievement and self confidence and in others a sense of failure and boredom. Since Forte started in 1994, we have seen many students achieve amazing results including Diplomas with Distinction. Conversely we have also experienced students who drop out of learning music altogether due to the exam experience.

When children are exposed to a positive examination experience from a young age, (*like the Foundation of Music Education exams designed for young beginner students*), as they move through the levels towards higher grades, they tend to be more engaged in the process.

How to make the decision towards doing exams?	At Forte, we’ve observed that at lower exam levels, around music grades 1 & 2, children are usually happy to follow the suggestions of teachers and parents. This will often change as students get older. Whatever his/her age, it is still important to discuss the pros and cons of exams with your child. Please take the time to discuss with your child’s music teacher what is expected when preparing for an exam. You and your child need to know whether he/she will be able to meet the expectations required to achieve a satisfactory result.																																																		
Is there enough time?	Together you and your child may like to create a weekly plan, which includes school and homework, other extra curricular (soccer, football, netball, dance, drama, etc) activities as well as musical instrument practice. During the preparation time for your child’s exam your encouragement and support will be essential for his/her success. To assist you, please feel free to download and use the free “My Weekly Plan” template. Once completed you may like to print it out and attach it to a notice board or your fridge at home. <table><tr><th></th><th>minutes per practice 5 x per week</th><th>minutes per practice 6 x per week</th><th>average weekly minutes practiced</th><th>hours required over 36 weeks</th></tr><tr><td>Preliminary/Initial</td><td>24</td><td>20</td><td>120</td><td>72</td></tr><tr><td>Grade 1</td><td>30</td><td>25</td><td>150</td><td>90</td></tr><tr><td>Grade 2</td><td>36</td><td>30</td><td>180</td><td>108</td></tr><tr><td>Grade 3</td><td>42</td><td>35</td><td>210</td><td>126</td></tr><tr><td>Grade 4</td><td>48</td><td>40</td><td>240</td><td>144</td></tr><tr><td>Grade 5</td><td>54</td><td>45</td><td>270</td><td>162</td></tr><tr><td>Grade 6</td><td>60</td><td>50</td><td>300</td><td>180</td></tr><tr><td>Grade 7</td><td>66</td><td>55</td><td>330</td><td>198</td></tr><tr><td>Grade 8</td><td>72</td><td>60</td><td>360</td><td>216</td></tr></table>		minutes per practice 5 x per week	minutes per practice 6 x per week	average weekly minutes practiced	hours required over 36 weeks	Preliminary/Initial	24	20	120	72	Grade 1	30	25	150	90	Grade 2	36	30	180	108	Grade 3	42	35	210	126	Grade 4	48	40	240	144	Grade 5	54	45	270	162	Grade 6	60	50	300	180	Grade 7	66	55	330	198	Grade 8	72	60	360	216
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Will they get bored?	Almost certainly! Preparing for an exam takes persistence, concentration, commitment and time. These are all good life skills, although some children may not yet be ready to learn them. Some families find that other activities crop up and/or other family matters arise that prevent children from putting in enough preparation prior to exam registration. If this happens, it certainly doesn't mean that your child can't do the exam in the future. When a student is making confident preparation they can be entered for an exam. Sometimes exam periods are 6 months to a year away, in this case some students may be able to just move to the next level. Exams don't have to be taken consecutively. Students can start at any level. Some teachers across the Forte network may choose to do an exam one year and then several grades higher two years later. We regularly have students move from Grade 1 to 3 then to 6 over short periods of time. Discuss the examination period closing date with your teacher.
What happens in an exam?	There are up to four parts to a music exam, two main sections: technical work and pieces; and then a selection depending on the exam of: general knowledge, aural tests, sight-reading and improvisation.
Technical Work	Firstly there will be technical work. This section is usually scales, arpeggios and broken chords. These are important foundational learning in music. Whilst this may be considered as the "boring" stuff, this will enhance your child's playing in the future. There is a trick to ensuring that technical work is well presented in an exam. Ensure your child practises the scales and arpeggios/broken chords regularly (like everyday, have a plan for this). Avoid practising just ascending and descending (up and down) scales, try a few different ways. Try down then up, a different rhythm or contrary motion then similar motion. Ask your teacher for some ideas and utilise the Forte Practice Buddy. The Practice Buddy has been designed to assist children with "whole brain" learning so that scales are learnt effectively and with correct technique. Each scale Practice Buddy offers independent hands followed by hands together at three different tempi (speeds), providing nine repetitions. Integrated repetition at different tempi is the key to whole brain learning to incorporate, mechanical, auditory and analytical memory.
Pieces	These are the works performed as the main body of the exam. It is important that the pieces are played well. Take every opportunity to perform the exam songs for anyone who'll listen! Perform the pieces at school, for grand parents, in church or at community functions. Any opportunity to perform in front of someone is great. Depending on the exam there may be three to five pieces required. Your teacher will work if your child to choose the songs for the exam. Most Examination Bodies will have a collection of set works and pieces that are required to be chosen from. As much as possible is important for your teacher and your child to choose pieces that the student is relate to. Sometimes you'll find that your child doesn't like a particular piece. Speak to your teacher if your child doesn't relate to

All About Music Exams

	a particular piece. Unfortunately there will be some pieces that your child will just have to “grin and bare it”. At the time, you may find children just hate the piece that they are performing. In the long term, it may be the best thing that they do – you and your child may not see the benefit of learning a particular song however it may give them great flexibility for their future performance skills. You will need to purchase the sheet music for every work performed. No photocopies are permitted in exams.
General Knowledge	Nearly every exam will require a Viva Voce. This is where the examiner will ask candidates about the pieces and/or works that they are performing. For all levels of exam students should be able to provide the examiner with information about the notes, key, time signature, form, style, signs and markings in the work they are performing. Students should also have some knowledge of the composer, their period within history and other works they have written. Whilst General Knowledge is a small part of the exam, a well prepared Viva Voce will offer students easy marks in an exam.
Aural Tests	This is often considered the “gold standard” for exams and a students’ ability to achieve a high result in this section will often be the difference between an average result and a high result. Many teachers will practice this area on a regular basis. It will require your child to sing and interpret music “aurally”. A great way to practice aural tests is to use an APP called “Aural Book” (available for iOS (iPod/iPad/iPhone) and Android) which will assist students to practice the aural tests required for each examination level. Student who have been learning in a Forte class will often have exceptional aural skills and achieve exceptional results in this part of an exam.
Sight Reading	Depending on the exam, this section will require a student to read and play a piece that that examiner provides them in the exam. In an exam a student’s ability to sight read will require them to read, interpret and perform a piece that they have never seen before. Successful sight-reading is a skill that takes time and practice. Again, there are some very good APPs, which will assist student to sight read effectively. Sight-reading is a skill that is learnt. Usually the ability to sight-read is 2-3 levels lower than the level that the student is being examined. Sight-reading can also be practiced by regularly playing new pieces and songs.
Improvisation (Creativity)	Some examination bodies will offer an improvisation section. This section is where a student is able to create a piece or song from given chord structure or motif. This area of an exam is usually own choice meaning that students may choose to participate in this section. Preparing for this section will require an extensive knowledge of chords (harmony) and creating a melody, which sounds good with a particular harmony. This is a challenging option, which is only offered by a few examination bodies. Students who enjoy creativity may find “easy” marks in this area.

The key to success in music exams is regular practice, commitment and effort! We hope that exams may offer your child a positive experience of music as well as the benefits in other areas of their lives.

Monday – Friday Timetable

	Monday	Tuesday	Wednesday	Thursday	Friday
6:00 am					
6:15 am					
6:30 am					
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7:00 PM					
7:15 PM					
7:30 PM					
7:45 PM					
Bed					

Free Download available to
workshop participants at:
www.easylearnmusic.com/sydcon

Weekend Timetable

	Saturday	Sunday
8:00 AM		
8:15 AM		
8:30 AM		
8:45 AM		
9:00 AM		
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General Knowledge

Name of Piece:	
Composer:	
Nationality:	
Dates:	
Music Period: Baroque / Classical / Romantic / 20 th Century or:	
Style & Form: Free Download available to workshop participants at: www.easylearnmusic.com/sydcon	
Key:	
Are there any modulations? 	
Time Signature:	
Explain the Time Signature:	
Signs & Terms 	Meaning/Explanation

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RIGHT

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LEFT

Time Names

An example of time names vocalisation.



Solfa Hand Signs

Doh



Ti



Lah



Soh



Fah



Mi



Ray



Doh

